Autumn Treats from Around the Globe

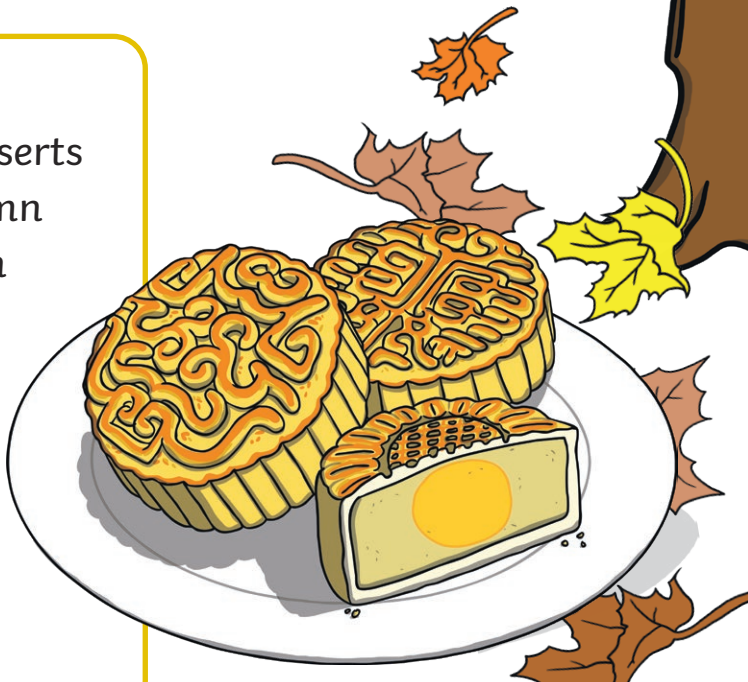
Pre-reading Questions

1. What kind of food or drink do you enjoy during autumn?
2. Have you ever tried any traditional autumn treats from different countries?
3. What ingredients do you think are commonly used in autumn baked goods?

Autumn is a season filled with warm colors, falling leaves, and delicious desserts enjoyed around the world. Let's explore some delightful sweet treats from different countries that are especially popular during this time of year.

Mooncakes - China

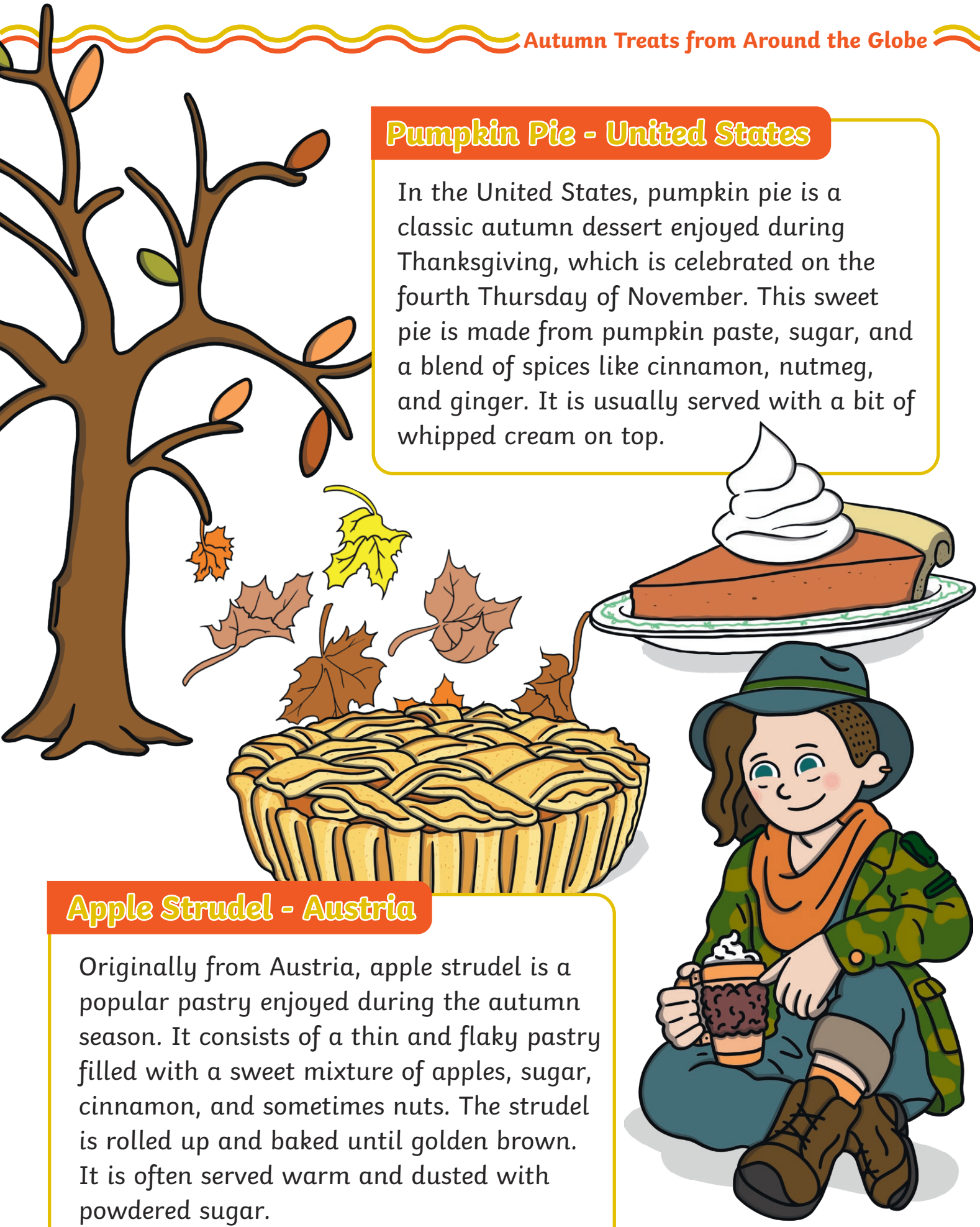
Mooncakes are traditional Chinese desserts that are enjoyed during the Mid-Autumn Festival, which is usually celebrated in September or October. These round pastries are filled with various sweet or savoury fillings, such as lotus seed paste or red bean paste and salted egg yolk. They are often beautifully decorated with detailed patterns and symbols.



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Pumpkin Pie - United States

In the United States, pumpkin pie is a classic autumn dessert enjoyed during Thanksgiving, which is celebrated on the fourth Thursday of November. This sweet pie is made from pumpkin paste, sugar, and a blend of spices like cinnamon, nutmeg, and ginger. It is usually served with a bit of whipped cream on top.



Apple Strudel - Austria

Originally from Austria, apple strudel is a popular pastry enjoyed during the autumn season. It consists of a thin and flaky pastry filled with a sweet mixture of apples, sugar, cinnamon, and sometimes nuts. The strudel is rolled up and baked until golden brown. It is often served warm and dusted with powdered sugar.

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Questions

Reading Comprehension Questions:

1. Which country is known for its pumpkin pie, and when is it typically eaten?

2. What are mooncakes, and when are they enjoyed?

3. What are the main ingredients used in apple strudel?

4. What is a common spice in the autumn desserts mentioned in the text?

5. Find an antonym for 'thick'.

Writing Questions

1. Which of these autumn desserts would you like to try the most? Why?

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2. Are there any autumn desserts from your country that are not mentioned in the text? Describe them.

3. Do you think special autumn treats are important to have at festivals? Why or why not?

Disclaimers: This resource has been made for the purpose of teaching English language learners. We know that students can be learning English in many different places, in many different ways and at age, so we try to keep these resources as general as possible.

There are many acronyms associated with English language teaching. These include (but are not limited to) ELT, TEFL, EFL, ELL, EAL and ESOL. While the term ESL may not fully represent the linguistic backgrounds of all students, it is the most widely recognised term for English language teaching globally. Therefore, we use the term 'ESL' in the names of our resources to make them easy to find but they are suitable for any student learning to speak English.

Answers

Reading Comprehension Questions:

1. The United States, and it is usually enjoyed during Thanksgiving.
2. Traditional Chinese desserts filled with sweet lotus seed paste or red bean paste and salted egg yolk. They are enjoyed during the Mid-Autumn Festival.
3. Apples, sugar, cinnamon, and sometimes nuts.
4. Cinnamon.
5. Thin.

Writing Questions

Students' own answers.